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Lead Software Developer

Companies House

Apply before 11:55 pm on Wednesday 2nd September 2026

Reference number

473620

Salary

£42,923 - £58,044

Base salary is £42,923 - £47,044 per year with an additional DDaT allowance of £4,350 - £11,000 per year available. The final salary and allowance awarded will be based on an assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated at interview. All our roles come with an excellent benefits package, including the generous Civil Service Pension Scheme. Further salary increases depend entirely upon the outcome of our annual pay negotiation with central government. If you are a current Civil Servant transferring to us, your salary will be discussed in line with our pay policies.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer
DDaT Lead

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

CH - Digital Services - Software Development

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

4

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Location

Remote working (anywhere in the UK)

About the job

Job summary

Are you a curious, adaptable and experienced Scrum Team Lead and Java developer, committed to continuous learning?

If you are looking for a place where you can focus on your own development as well as support others to succeed and perform at their best, then this is the role for you.

We're looking for talented **Lead Software Developers** to join Companies House and play a key role in transforming corporate governance through the Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act.

Our modern digital services are built primarily using Java with Spring Boot and TypeScript with Node.js and Express, alongside the GOV.UK Design System. We're also modernising a number of legacy applications as part of an ambitious transformation programme.

We are currently looking for expert developers in Java using the Spring Boot framework. We like to hire inquisitive developers who value continuous learning, and we will support you in learning all the development technologies we use at Companies House. As a Lead Developer, over time you will be expected to be familiar with all the technologies in use at

Companies House, including multiple languages and frameworks (Typescript, Node, Express, Go and others).

Watch this video to find out more about working in Digital at Companies House

Companies House offers a flexible and welcoming culture that promotes a healthy work life balance as well as a proactive approach to wellbeing that allows us to be our best at work. We recognise that people are the key to our success so offer a fantastic benefits package including flexible working with no core hours, 30 days annual leave, 8 bank holidays and 1 privilege day as well as enrolment into the Civil Service Pension scheme with a contribution rate averaging 28%.

Find out more about what a great place Companies House is to work

Please note:

Companies House cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign.

Security Clearance is an essential requirement for this campaign. You'll need to have been in the UK for at least 3 out of the last 5 years to be eligible to apply for SC.

Job description

As a Lead Developer, you'll manage and develop a Scrum team of around eight developers of varying experience levels. Working in a multidisciplinary agile team, you'll provide technical leadership, coaching and mentoring, helping your team deliver high-quality services that sit at the heart of our organisation.

As a Lead Developer, you will:

Provide technical leadership to your team

Coach and support your team to upskill their technical capabilities and ensure they design and deliver efficient and maintainable solutions

Advocate and lead the adoption of developer AI tooling within your team

Take technical ownership of release increments for services your team is responsible for

Communicate between the product owners and developers to ensure key deliverables are achieved and understood by both parties

Work with the wider developer community to define and document technical standards

Work to ensure your services are up to date by resolving security vulnerabilities according to our security policy

Help and encourage your team to maximise their automated test coverage

Work closely with the Architects for design and the Platform team who manage our development pipeline using Concourse CI SonarQube, AWS, Terraform and Artifactory. We use Docker containers and AWS ECS

Take the lead in sharing your knowledge and experience within our software development and lead software developer communities

We actively invest in learning, innovation and professional development. Developers are given dedicated time to explore new ideas, develop their skills and keep pace with industry trends. You'll have access to online learning, instructor-led training, conferences (subject to budget), and a thriving developer community of practice.

You will be joining a passionate team of Developers with varying levels of technical abilities. There are many other experienced Lead Developers and Principal Developers within Companies House, so you will be surrounded by a friendly community of experts who will fully support you.

You can read more about a career in Digital and Data within the Civil Service in the [Government Digital and Data Candidate Information Pack](#).

Person specification

We're looking for the following experience and technical capabilities, which will be assessed at sift and at interview.

Excellent coding skills which must include demonstrable experience of Java and Spring Boot for Enterprise or microservice architectures

Experience of leading a scrum team.

Strong communication skills where you can translate technical jargon into simple, clear descriptions so understanding is achieved.

Experience of using agile techniques/methodologies.

Understanding of full stack web technologies,

Practical knowledge of SQL and NoSQL databases,

Application of industry standard software development working practices such as test-driven and behaviour-driven development (TDD/BDD), pair programming, version control and branching strategies,

Continuous Integration/Continuous Development,

Application of software design patterns.

Knowledge and understanding of developing and running applications securely in Cloud environments.

AWS/Docker/Terraform.

Knowledge of industry standard security practices.

If you have knowledge of Typescript / Express / Node that will be considered a bonus.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Changing and Improving

Developing Self and Others

Delivering at Pace

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

REST Interfaces

Web

Security

Containers

Programming and Build

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £42,923, Companies House contributes £12,434 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\)](#).

We believe that our success is driven by the well-being and satisfaction of our team members at all levels of the organisation. At Companies House we re committed to providing a comprehensive benefits package that goes beyond the ordinary, ensuring your career journey with us is not only fulfilling, but also rewarding. We pride ourselves on offering a quality work-life balance with our employee wellbeing being central to our working practices.

Head to [Our benefits - Working for us - Recruitment \(companieshouse.gov.uk\)](#) to find out more about the fantastic benefits package we have at Companies House.

We celebrate diversity...

As an equal opportunity employer, we celebrate diversity, being committed to ensuring we re representative of the citizens we serve and creating an inclusive environment. Everyone in Companies House brings something different, and so will you. To fulfil our commitment to recruiting and attracting diverse talent we welcome applications from underrepresented groups. We also welcome applications from Welsh speakers.

We are proud to be a disability confident leader. Our recruitment process is fully inclusive and we can make adjustments as needed through our process. These could include having an interview buddy, extra time at interviews/ assessments and receiving interview questions in advance, to name a few.

If you require any reasonable adjustments at application stage, or if you'd like to discuss any person-centred adjustments, please contact us by emailing recruitmentCH@companieshouse.gov.uk.

Read our ['Applying under the Disability Confidence Scheme \(DCS\)'](#) guide to find out how to successfully complete an application under the Disability Confidence Scheme (DCS).

Where will you be working?

We are currently using a hybrid approach to the way we work which provides opportunities for you to be adaptable in the way you work so that you can achieve a healthy balance between your work and home life. The degree of choice you have will depend on your role and your day-to-day work activities.

Your manager will agree regular patterns of attendance with you; however, you may be required to make yourself available to attend the office more frequently when required to meet business needs.

A hybrid employment contract will be provided as the standard offering. However, remote contracts may be considered as an exception whereby commuting to our Cardiff or Edinburgh office location is not reasonably practicable.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Strengths, Experience and Technical skills.

What will the process look like?

Key Dates (dates are indicative only and could be subject to change)

Closing date: 2nd September 2026 at 23:55

Sifting: from 3rd September 2026 onwards

Interviews: from 16th September 2026 onwards via Microsoft Teams

Stage 1 Sift

An initial sift of applications will be carried out to create a shortlist. This will be based on the evidence provided for the following Success Profile elements: Experience.

In your application form we'd like you to:

Write a CV: Tell us about your employment history, key responsibilities, projects worked on and achievements specifically relevant to the role responsibilities and experience required as detailed above. We're keen to know the depth of your skills and experience so please include any details to demonstrate these. We'd specifically like to know what projects you worked on, for how long, what was your role, what technologies you used and project outcomes.

Write a Personal Statement of 750 words: tell us, using work-based examples to demonstrate your level of skill, how you the following three role requirements:

Excellent coding skills which must include demonstrable experience of Java and Spring Boot for Enterprise or microservice architectures

Experience of leading a scrum team.

Strong communication skills where you can translate technical jargon into simple, clear descriptions so understanding is achieved.

We'd encourage you to use the full word count, and to give us clear examples and evidence of the different elements of the essential minimum criteria.

We're committed to being diverse and inclusive, so please make your application anonymous by removing all identifying personal information (such as your name and age) from your personal statement.

Once the advert has closed, we will sift applications - this involves reading through them all, please bear with us as this can take some time.

We may raise the score required if we receive a high number of applications.

At sift we may choose to take through the highest performing candidates to the next stage. If, after the final stage is completed and roles are unfilled, we will proceed to invite lower scoring candidates to interview.

Stage 2 - Interview

Companies House uses a blended interview technique, allowing us to find out more about you. We use the Success Profile framework and at interview we will use Success Profiles assessing the **Behaviours and Technical Skills** listed in the advert, and **Strengths**.

Successful candidates from the sift stage will be invited to a virtual interview, which will be conducted using Microsoft Teams.

As part of the interview, you will be asked to complete a coding exercise. Details will be emailed to you 1 hour before your interview start time. You'll have 1 hour to work through the activity and then you'll join the Teams call at your interview start time. You'll be asked to screen share, discussing the exercise with the panel and answering some live questions to demonstrate your level of skill. This will be assessing **Technical Skill: Programming and build**.

The lead criteria to distinguish between tied candidates will be: **Leadership**.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months from which further appointments may be made for the same or similar roles.

If after the interview you are not found appointable at the advertised grade, you may be offered the lower grade role of Senior Software Developer, if you are considered to meet the skills, experience and behaviours for the lower

level. The benchmark for appointing to the lower grade is set at the start of each campaign.

All offers will be made in merit order.

Our recruitment process is underpinned by the principle of recruitment based on fair and open competition with decisions made on the basis of merit, as outlined in the Civil Service Commissioners' Recruitment Principles.

Sponsorship

Companies House **cannot** offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. Companies House holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles, and this campaign does not qualify. Should you apply for this role and require sponsorship, your application may be rejected, and any provisional offers of employment withdrawn.

Security Clearance

Successful candidates must pass a Baseline Personnel Security Standard (BPSS) check before they can be appointed.

BPSS is an entry level security check. It uses the Police National Computer (PNC) to make sure a candidate has no convictions. The check returns evidence of any current criminal record and un-spent convictions under the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements for Security Check (SC) before they can be appointed.

The requirement for SC clearance is to have been present in the UK for at least 3 of the last 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements will result in your security clearance application being rejected.

[Further information on National Security Vetting](#)

Pre-Employment Checking

In line with Government guidance, successfully appointed candidates will need to provide documents for our Right to Work checks.

From June 2026, applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). Your personal details (name, National Insurance number, and date of birth) will be checked against the Civil Service Resourcing Extract IFD.

This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued.

If your details appear on this database, you will not be offered employment unless you can demonstrate exceptional circumstances. Companies House, acting on behalf of the vacancy holder, will inform you if your application is refused for this reason.

Please note: You are not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Georga Coleman

Email : gcoleman@companieshouse.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : recruitmentch@companieshouse.gov.uk

Further information

We welcome applications in Welsh / Rydym yn croesawi ceisiadau yn y Gymraeg. Selection for appointment to the Civil Service is on merit, on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. In accordance with the Civil Service Commissioners' Recruitment Principles, our recruitment and selection processes are underpinned by the requirement of appointment on the basis of merit by fair and open competition. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact infopoint@companieshouse.gov.uk in the first instance. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can

contact the Civil Service Commission.

info@csc.gov.uk

Civil Service Commission, Room G/8, 1 Horse Guards Road SW1A 2HQ

